WEBSITE AUDIT EVALUATION BENCHMARK

Standardized 5-Pillar Evaluation Criteria & Scoring Rubric (v2.4)

This reference framework establishes rigorous standards for assessing commercial and SaaS websites. Each dimension is scored on an objective 1 to 10 scale, where 1 represents severe commercial risk and 10 represents industry-leading execution. Every finding must be backed by verifiable verbatim quotes or observable metrics directly extracted from the target website.

1. Technical SEO & Metadata

Evaluation Factor	Standard & Benchmark Expectation
Title Tag Optimization	Specific, keyword-relevant, between 40-60 characters, with company branding.
Meta Description & OpenGraph	Compelling summary under 160 characters. Proper og:title and og:image tags.
Semantic Heading Hierarchy	Single, high-impact H1 describing core offering; logical H2/H3 sub-structure.
Crawlability & Canonicalization	Proper canonical tags, robots directives, and search bot friendly internal linking.

2. Speed, Performance & Mobile Responsiveness

Evaluation Factor	Standard & Benchmark Expectation
Initial Page Load Speed	Server response time (TTFB) < 600ms; multi-page requests succeed without timeout.
Viewport & Mobile Meta	Accurate viewport declaration: width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0.
Resource Bloat & Scripting	Excessive third-party trackers, uncompressed media assets, and blocking scripts.

3. Content Clarity & Value Proposition

Evaluation Factor	Standard & Benchmark Expectation
Hero Section Clarity (5-Second Test)	Visitors must understand within 5 seconds: What is offered, for whom, and why it matters.
Benefit vs. Feature Ratio	Focus on customer outcomes and quantified impact rather than self-referential jargon.
Readability & Typography	Scannable typography, descriptive subheadings, bullet points, and concise paragraphs.

4. Conversion Architecture & UX

Evaluation Factor	Standard & Benchmark Expectation
Call-to-Action (CTA) Prominence	High-contrast, benefit-oriented CTA visible above the fold and at key decision points.
Form Friction & Lead Capture	Minimal input fields for top-of-funnel conversion; low cognitive friction.
Navigation Simplicity	Clean primary header menu with no more than 5-7 intuitive top-level navigation items.

5. Trust Signals, Security & Compliance

Evaluation Factor	Standard & Benchmark Expectation
SSL & HTTPS Security	Secure transport protocol across all assets with valid certificates.
Social Proof & Testimonials	Named customer testimonials, verifiable logos, case studies, or metric proof.
Clear Contact & Legal Info	Accessible physical address, support email/phone, privacy policy, and terms of service.

Scoring Scale & Classification

Score Band	Classification	Action Required
1 - 4	Critical Deficiency	Immediate technical or messaging overhaul necessary.
5 - 6	Below Benchmark	Noticeable conversion leaks and missed revenue opportunities.
7 - 8	Competitive Standard	Solid execution; tactical enhancements will yield gains.
9 - 10	Exemplary	Benchmark-setting execution; minimal friction.